

ANTONIN DVORAK

The “conservative” Brahms and the “progressive” Wagner were at opposite ends of the spectrum in Romantic music. Dvořák was influenced by both. His operas, including *Rusalka* (1901), are full of Wagnerian references. Even his early chamber music and symphonies (notably No. 4) have grand Wagnerian gestures and echoes of his favorite Wagner opera, *Tannhäuser* (1845). But some of Dvořák’s works of the 1880s have strong similarities to Brahms. The first and last movements of his Symphony No. 6, for example, are evocative of Brahms’s Symphony No. 2, notably in mood, key, tempo, orchestration, theme, and motif.



RUSALKA

This 2006 production of Antonín Dvořák’s most notable opera, *Rusalka*, is from the Prague National Opera House. The work resembles Hans Christian Andersen’s fairy tale *The Little Mermaid* and includes rhapsodically poetic music.